

Cumulative Final EXCEPT/NOT Pack

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac. | Final: Friday, Sept. 11, 2026
"Which of the Following Is NOT/EXCEPT" Format · Weeks 1–9

- TCM for Ballroom Dancers
- reMarkable Edition

How to use this pack: This trains the format itself, not just the content — "EXCEPT" questions trip people up independent of how well they know the material, because you have to hold all four options in mind and find the one false statement among three true ones. Read every option fully before choosing; don't stop at the first one that sounds right. Best used once your content feels solid from the Study Guide, Cram Sheet, and Drill/Quiz Packs. Week 5 is intentionally absent (midterm week, no new content).

1 • Week 1 — Vital Substances

1. All of the following are among the six functions of Qi EXCEPT:

- A) Transporting
- B) Warming
- C) Cooling
- D) Holding

2. All of the following are true of Qi Stagnation EXCEPT:

- A) More distension than pain
- B) Pain is fixed and stabbing
- C) Pulse is typically Wiry
- D) Tongue is normal or slightly red on the sides

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the four Qi pathology patterns?

- A) Qi Deficiency
- B) Qi Stagnation
- C) Qi Collapse
- D) Rebellious Qi

4. All of the following are functions of Blood EXCEPT:

- A) Nourishes tissues and organs
- B) Houses the Shen
- C) Circulates with Wei Qi
- D) Moistens the body, skin, sinews, eyes

5. All of the following are signs of Blood Deficiency EXCEPT:

- A) Pale lips
- B) Dizziness
- C) Stabbing fixed pain
- D) Scanty periods

6. All of the following are true of Jīn (as opposed to Yè) EXCEPT:

- A) Clear and watery
- B) Circulates with Wei Qi
- C) Moves slowly
- D) Controlled by the Lung

7. All of the following are among the Five Spirits (Wu Shen) EXCEPT:

- A) Shén (Heart)
- B) Hún (Liver)
- C) Wèi (Stomach)
- D) Zhì (Kidney)

8. All of the following are true of False Shen EXCEPT:

- A) Occurs in critically ill patients
- B) Represents genuine recovery
- C) Involves a sudden brightening of the eyes
- D) Is often followed shortly by death

2 • Week 2 — Eight Principles

1. All of the following are true of an Exterior pattern EXCEPT:

- A) Fever and aversion to cold occur simultaneously
- B) Pulse is typically Floating
- C) Coating is typically thin
- D) Aversion to cold has resolved while fever persists

2. All of the following are found in Full-Heat (Excess Yang) EXCEPT:

- A) Redness over the entire face
- B) Thick yellow tongue coating
- C) Malar flush only, with no coating
- D) Strong, Rapid, Full pulse

3. All of the following are signs of Collapse of Yang EXCEPT:

- A) Cold limbs
- B) Constipation and retention of urine
- C) Profuse oily sweating
- D) Minute-Deep pulse

4. Which of the following is NOT a sign of Collapse of Yin?

- A) Abundant perspiration
- B) Hot limbs
- C) Chilliness and incontinence
- D) Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse

5. All of the following are true in False Heat/True Cold EXCEPT:

- A) Cheeks may appear red but the color is superficial, like powder
- B) Patient desires cold drinks and gulps them down
- C) Voice is quiet and low
- D) Pulse may appear Rapid and Floating but is actually Empty

3 · Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

1. All of the following are correctly paired with their Nan Jing pulse position EXCEPT:

- A) Left Cun — Heart/Small Intestine
- B) Left Guan — Liver/Gallbladder
- C) Right Chi — Kidney/Bladder
- D) Right Guan — Spleen/Stomach

2. All of the following are components of a normal pulse EXCEPT:

- A) Wèi (Stomach-Qi)
- B) Shén (Spirit)
- C) Gēn (Root)
- D) Xié (Pathogenic factor)

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the four seasonal pulses?

- A) Spring — Wiry
- B) Summer — Flooding
- C) Autumn — Hair-like
- D) Winter — Slippery

4. All of the following are true of a Floating pulse EXCEPT:

- A) Can indicate Exterior Wind invasion
- B) Can indicate Yin Deficiency
- C) Always confirms an Exterior pattern with no exceptions
- D) Felt at the superficial level with light pressure

5. All of the following pulse qualities involve an irregular or interrupted rhythm EXCEPT:

- A) Knotted (Jié)
- B) Hasty (Cù)
- C) Intermittent (Dài)
- D) Wiry (Xián)

4 • Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis

1. All of the following medications are correctly paired with their tongue effect EXCEPT:

- A) Antibiotics — peeled patches
- B) Corticosteroids — red, swollen tongue
- C) Diuretics — thick black coating
- D) Antineoplastics — thick brown/black dry coating

2. All of the following are true of purple tongue discoloration EXCEPT:

- A) Always indicates Blood Stasis
- B) Reddish-purple indicates stasis from Heat
- C) Bluish-purple indicates stasis from Cold
- D) Can sometimes indicate simple Qi Deficiency instead of Blood Stasis

3. All of the following are causes of tongue cracks EXCEPT:

- A) Yin Deficiency
- B) Excess Dampness pooling on the surface
- C) Excessive Heat consuming fluids
- D) Deficiency of Essence and Blood

4. Which of the following is NOT true of tongue coating?

- A) A thick coating always indicates a pathogenic factor
- B) Coating with root indicates Stomach Qi is intact even if color/thickness is abnormal
- C) Coating is unaffected by food, drink, or medication
- D) Absence of coating indicates Stomach Qi/Yin is severely weakened

5. All of the following indicate Blood Stasis on tongue exam EXCEPT:

- A) Purple tongue body
- B) Distended, dark sublingual veins
- C) Pale, thin tongue body
- D) Fixed, stabbing pain with the tongue findings

5 • Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation

1. All of the following are correctly paired on the Su Wen 32 face map EXCEPT:

- A) Forehead — Heart
- B) Nose — Spleen
- C) Chin — Kidney
- D) Patient's left cheek — Lung

2. All of the following are among the Five Wheels of the Eye EXCEPT:

- A) Blood Wheel — Heart
- B) Qi Wheel — Lung
- C) Fire Wheel — Heart (duplicate)
- D) Water Wheel — Kidney

3. All of the following are signs of "Having Shen" EXCEPT:

- A) Bright, moist complexion
- B) Alert, vivid eyes
- C) Confused, incoherent speech
- D) Even respiration

4. All of the following are true of the five Bi Syndrome types EXCEPT:

- A) Wandering Bi is caused by Wind
- B) Painful Bi is caused by Cold
- C) Heat Bi has sudden onset with swelling and redness
- D) Bone Bi is the earliest, mildest stage

5. Which of the following is NOT a cause of non-pitting edema?

- A) Qi Stagnation
- B) Dampness
- C) Spleen-Yang Deficiency (pitting type)
- D) Both A and B are valid causes of non-pitting edema

6 · Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry

1. All of the following are part of Schrier's expanded 16 Questions (beyond Maciocia's 10) EXCEPT:

- A) Pain
- B) Emotions
- C) Sexual Symptoms
- D) Previous Illness

2. All of the following point to an Empty (Deficiency) pain pattern EXCEPT:

- A) Alleviated by pressure
- B) Alleviated by rest
- C) Aggravated by food
- D) Dull quality

3. All of the following are causes of Wandering Bi-type joint pain EXCEPT:

- A) Wind
- B) Pain moves joint to joint
- C) Nothing is fixed in location
- D) Severe, unrelenting, fixed pain

4. Which of the following is NOT one of the three root mechanisms of bleeding?

- A) Heat pushing Blood out
- B) Tension/pressure forcing Blood out
- C) Deficiency failing to hold Blood in
- D) Wind scattering Blood outward

5. All of the following are true of insomnia patterns EXCEPT:

- A) Can't fall/stay asleep = Blood Deficiency (Empty)
- B) Restless with vivid dreaming and heat = pathogens agitating Shen/Hun (Full)
- C) Waking early = Gall Bladder deficiency
- D) All insomnia patterns are Full/Excess in nature

7 · Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation

1. All of the following are among the three palpation techniques EXCEPT:

- A) Palpation (tracing)
- B) Pressing
- C) Feeling
- D) Pulsing

2. All of the following are true of the Nan Jing Five-Phase abdominal map EXCEPT:

- A) Above navel corresponds to Heart/Fire
- B) At navel corresponds to Spleen/Earth
- C) Below navel corresponds to Lung/Metal
- D) Right side under ribs corresponds to Lung/Metal

3. Which of the following is NOT a correct pairing per Ling Shu 74?

- A) Dorsal (back of hand) heat — Full Heat
- B) Palm heat — Empty Heat
- C) Dorsal heat — Empty Heat
- D) Both A and B are correct pairings

4. All of the following are true of Xu Li (apical beat) findings EXCEPT:

- A) Feeble = Zong Qi deficiency
- B) Strong/hard = Excess Lung/Heart
- C) Large but empty = Heart-Qi deficiency
- D) Stop-start pattern = excellent prognosis

8 · Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

1. All of the following are correctly matched Five-Element sounds EXCEPT:

- A) Shouting — Wood
- B) Laughing — Fire
- C) Singing — Metal
- D) Groaning — Water

2. All of the following are true of the voice-organ relationship EXCEPT:

- A) Lung governs production of sound
- B) Kidney governs volume of the voice
- C) Spleen/Stomach govern strength of the voice
- D) Liver governs the pitch of the voice

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the categories covered under Wén Zhén (Hearing & Smelling)?

- A) Voice
- B) Breathing
- C) Pulse quality
- D) Body odor

4. All of the following indicate a Full pattern EXCEPT:

- A) Loud voice
- B) Loud, explosive cough
- C) Weak, quiet breathing
- D) Loud, long belching

5. All of the following are true of the "Scorched" odor discussion EXCEPT:

- A) The classical character is 焦 (jiāo)
- B) The course slide uses 笑 (xiào) instead
- C) This discrepancy has been confirmed as intentional by Prof. Schrier
- D) Examples given include burnt toast and a scorched shirt

Answer Key — Weeks 1-4

Week 1 — Vital Substances

#	Ans	Why
1	C	"Cooling" isn't one of the six functions — they are Transporting, Warming, Protecting, Holding, Transforming, Rising.
2	B	Fixed, stabbing pain describes Blood Stasis, not Qi Stagnation (which is more distension than pain, moving).
3	C	"Qi Collapse" isn't one of the four — they are Deficiency, Sinking, Stagnation, Rebellious.
4	C	Blood circulates with Ying Qi, not Wei Qi (Wei Qi is Defensive Qi, associated with Fluids/Jin).
5	C	Stabbing fixed pain is a Blood Stasis sign, not Blood Deficiency.
6	C	Jīn moves quickly; it's Yè that moves slowly.
7	C	"Wèi" is not one of the Five Spirits — the Spleen's spirit is Yì, not Wèi.
8	B	False Shen is NOT genuine recovery — it's a final flare before decline, often followed by death.

Week 2 — Eight Principles

#	Ans	Why
1	D	Aversion to cold resolving while fever persists is the marker of progression to Interior, not a feature of Exterior.
2	C	Malar flush only, no coating, is the Empty-Heat picture, not Full-Heat.

3	B	Collapse of Yang presents with frequent urination/incontinence, NOT constipation and retention (that's Collapse of Yin).
4	C	Chilliness and incontinence describe Collapse of Yang, not Collapse of Yin (which is hot, dry, with retention/constipation).
5	B	In False Heat/True Cold, the patient has thirst WITHOUT desire to drink, or prefers warm fluids in small sips — not gulping cold drinks.

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

#	Ans	Why
1	C	Right Chi = Pericardium/San Jiao, not Kidney/Bladder (that's Left Chi).
2	D	Xié (pathogenic factor) is not a component of a NORMAL pulse — normal = Wèi+Shén+Gēn.
3	D	Winter's seasonal pulse is Stone, not Slippery.
4	C	Floating does NOT always confirm Exterior — it can also indicate Yin Deficiency.
5	D	Wiry describes tension/shape, not rhythm irregularity — Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent all involve irregular/interrupted rhythm.

Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis

#	Ans	Why
1	C	Diuretics cause peeling, not a thick black coating.
2	D	Purple ALWAYS indicates Blood Stasis, with no exception for simple Qi Deficiency.
3	B	Cracks are caused by dryness/deficiency mechanisms; excess Dampness pooling is not a standard cause of cracking.
4	C	Coating is easily affected by food, drink, and medication — that's precisely why you must ask before concluding a pattern from it.
5	C	Pale, thin tongue body indicates Blood Deficiency, not Blood Stasis.

Answer Key — Weeks 6–9

Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation

#	Ans	Why
1	D	Patient's LEFT cheek corresponds to Liver, not Lung — Lung is the patient's RIGHT cheek. The mirror-trap in action.
2	C	There is no "Fire Wheel" among the Five Wheels — they are Blood, Qi, Wind, Water, and Flesh.
3	C	Confused, incoherent speech is a sign of LOSS of Shen, not Having Shen.
4	D	Bone Bi is the chronic, deep, LATE-stage progression of the other four — not the earliest/mildest.
5	C	Pitting edema is the Yang Deficiency type; it is not a cause of non-pitting edema.

Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry

#	Ans	Why
1	D	"Previous Illness" is part of Maciocia's original 10, not one of Schrier's 4 additions (Pain, Emotions, Sexual Symptoms, Energy Level).
2	C	Aggravated by food is a Full-pattern sign, not Empty.
3	D	Severe, unrelenting, FIXED pain describes Painful Bi (Cold), not Wandering Bi.
4	D	"Wind scattering Blood" is not one of the three recognized bleeding mechanisms.
5	D	Insomnia patterns include BOTH Empty (Blood deficiency) and Full (pathogen-agitated) types — not exclusively Full.

Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation

#	Ans	Why
1	D	"Pulsing" is not one of the three techniques — they are Palpation, Pressing, and Feeling.
2	C	Below the navel corresponds to Kidney/Water, not Lung/Metal (Lung/Metal is the right side under the ribs).
3	C	Dorsal (back of hand) heat = Full Heat, not Empty Heat, per Ling Shu 74.
4	D	A stop-start Xu Li pattern indicates shock or poor prognosis, not an excellent one.

Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

#	Ans	Why
1	C	Singing corresponds to Earth, not Metal (Weeping is Metal).
2	D	The Liver is not classically assigned to control pitch of the voice in this framework — the three organs are Lung, Kidney, and Spleen/Stomach.
3	C	Pulse quality is assessed under Palpation (Week 8), not Hearing & Smelling.
4	C	Weak, quiet breathing indicates an Empty pattern, not Full.
5	C	This discrepancy is flagged for confirmation with Prof. Schrier — it has NOT been confirmed as intentional.